

HUA TONG

HCI & Interaction Design Researcher • Architecture + HCI Dual Major • Tangible Interaction & Digital Fabrication

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Interdisciplinary designer with a dual background in Architecture and Human-Computer Interaction at Carnegie Mellon University. Specialized in tangible interaction, digital fabrication, wearable HCI, and AI-augmented design. Proficient in end-to-end prototyping from concept to physical implementation, with hands-on experience in electronic prototyping, user research, and cross-disciplinary collaboration. Eager to contribute to research on flexible electronics, smart wearables, and future human-computer interaction systems.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Architecture, Additional Major in HCI — Carnegie Mellon University

Aug 2022 – May 2026

- Dean's List 2024–2025

SELECTED ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Soft Fabrication Collaborator — Inflatable Installation, CMU IDEATe (Prof. Olivia Robinson)

Jan – Apr 2026

- Modeling organic freeform components in Blender and UV-mapping into flat sewing patterns for a large-scale inflatable installation
- Developing hands-on expertise in **soft-material deformation** by iterating on internal reinforcements to control inflated geometry

Computational Designer — Pollen Vertical Farm (Prof. Vernelle A. A. Noel)

Jan – Apr 2024

- Led **parametric exploration in Grasshopper**; computed joint angles for 5 joint types via edge-face mirroring logic
- Produced drawing set, laser-cut prototype, and co-completed CNC-routed final at architectural scale—**end-to-end digital fabrication**

Sole Designer & Researcher — Trace: Feminist History Board Game (Theodossis Issaias, Special Faculty)

Jan – Apr 2024

- Designed a **tangible narrative system** on a hexagonal grid; translated archival research into game mechanics via **combinatorics**
- Playtested with 8+ participants, iterating spatial mechanics and card balance based on qualitative feedback

WORK EXPERIENCE

UI/UX Design Intern — Moonton, Shanghai

May – Jul 2025

- Designed activity interfaces in Adobe XD; integrated assets into **Unity**, bridging digital design with real-time interactive systems
- Collaborated across engineering, art, and product teams in cross-department design reviews

UI/UX Design Intern — Minimax, Beijing

Jul – Aug 2024

- Designed spatial interaction sequences for *Rolling Sky* (50M+ downloads) using Adobe Suite, Rhino, and Unity

UI/UX Design Intern — Cheetah Mobile, Beijing

Jun – Jul 2024

- Redesigned product interfaces in Figma/Sketch; explored **AI-augmented design** with Stable Diffusion and Midjourney

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Freelance Illustrator & Content Creator

Mar 2025 – Present

- 3,000+ followers on Xiaohongshu; 80+ commissions for 100+ clients—strong **visual communication** and iterative design

Designer & Constructor — CMU Spring Carnival Pavilion

Mar – Apr 2024

- Full-cycle **architectural-scale fabrication**: design, procurement, structural assembly, and construction under deadline

Designer & Constructor — Southeast University Summer Camp, Nanjing

Jul – Aug 2023

- Studied traditional Chinese timber joinery; constructed a full-scale wooden pavilion and managed material logistics

SKILLS

HCI & Prototyping: Design Thinking • Wireframing • Prototyping • User Research • Physical Computing (Arduino) • Illustration

Digital Fabrication: CNC Routing • Laser Cutting • Sewing & Inflatable Fabrication • Woodwork

Software: Grasshopper for Rhino • Blender • Maya • Fusion 360 • ZBrush • Nomad • Unity • Adobe Creative Suite • Figma • Sketch

Programming: Python • C • C# • HTML

Languages: English (fluent) • Chinese (native)